

402MAN Session 5

Organisational Communication



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Guardian University Guide 2016-2020

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Teaching Excellence
Framework (TEF) 2017

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DLHE survey, UG UK, 2016/17
(published 2018)

Module Learning Outcomes

1. **Demonstrate** a knowledge of the **core principles, theories** and differing methods of communication and collaboration within a range of organisational contexts.
2. **Reflect** upon their **own interpersonal, communication and collaborative skills** and identify areas for improvement.
3. **Demonstrate** an **understanding of working with others, teamwork, groups** and group dynamics and across organisational boundaries.
4. **Demonstrate** a knowledge of **how to communicate and collaborate** effectively using appropriate techniques
5. **Explain** how **management, organisational culture and structure** can impact communication and collaboration within and between organisations.
6. **Explain** **effective communication and collaboration** within an organisation.

Session Learning Outcomes

- ✓ Define **formal** and **informal communication**
 - ✓ Identify key differences between them
 - ✓ Understand different **communication flows** in organizations (downward, upward, horizontal, diagonal)
 - ✓ Discuss their impact on organizational effectiveness
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What is happening in the world?

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NEWS

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Southport attack yoga teacher: 'If I didn't get out, everyone was going to die'

Leanne Lucas and a teenage girl give the first survivors' accounts from within the room where three children were fatally stabbed last summer.



▶ 6:47

Leanne Lucas describes desperately helping children despite being stabbed five times

UK · 4h



LIVE Germany's Merz calls for 'independence' from US after election win

Europe



New German leader signals seismic shift in transatlantic relations

Europe · 2h



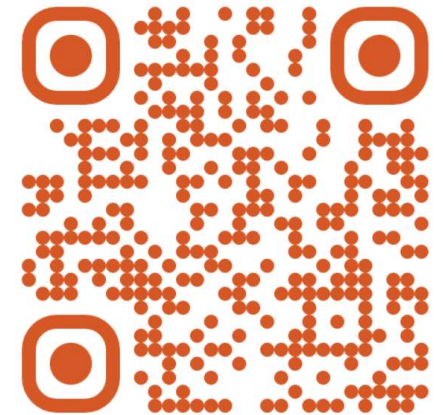
LIVE European leaders



Jeremy Bowen: Three



Moore and Chalamet are





Question Time

1. What is organisational communication?
2. What is downward communication?
3. What is upward communication?
4. What causes communication breakdown in the workplace?

Organisational Communication is ...

According to De Ridder (2004) it is *“the ways in which groups of people maintain structure and order through their symbolic interactions and allow individual actors the freedom to accomplish their goals”*

Why is effective organisational communication essential?

DISCUSS

- What has been happening in America with the DOGE (Department of Government Efficiency)?
- Is this effective communication?
- What challenges does this pose?



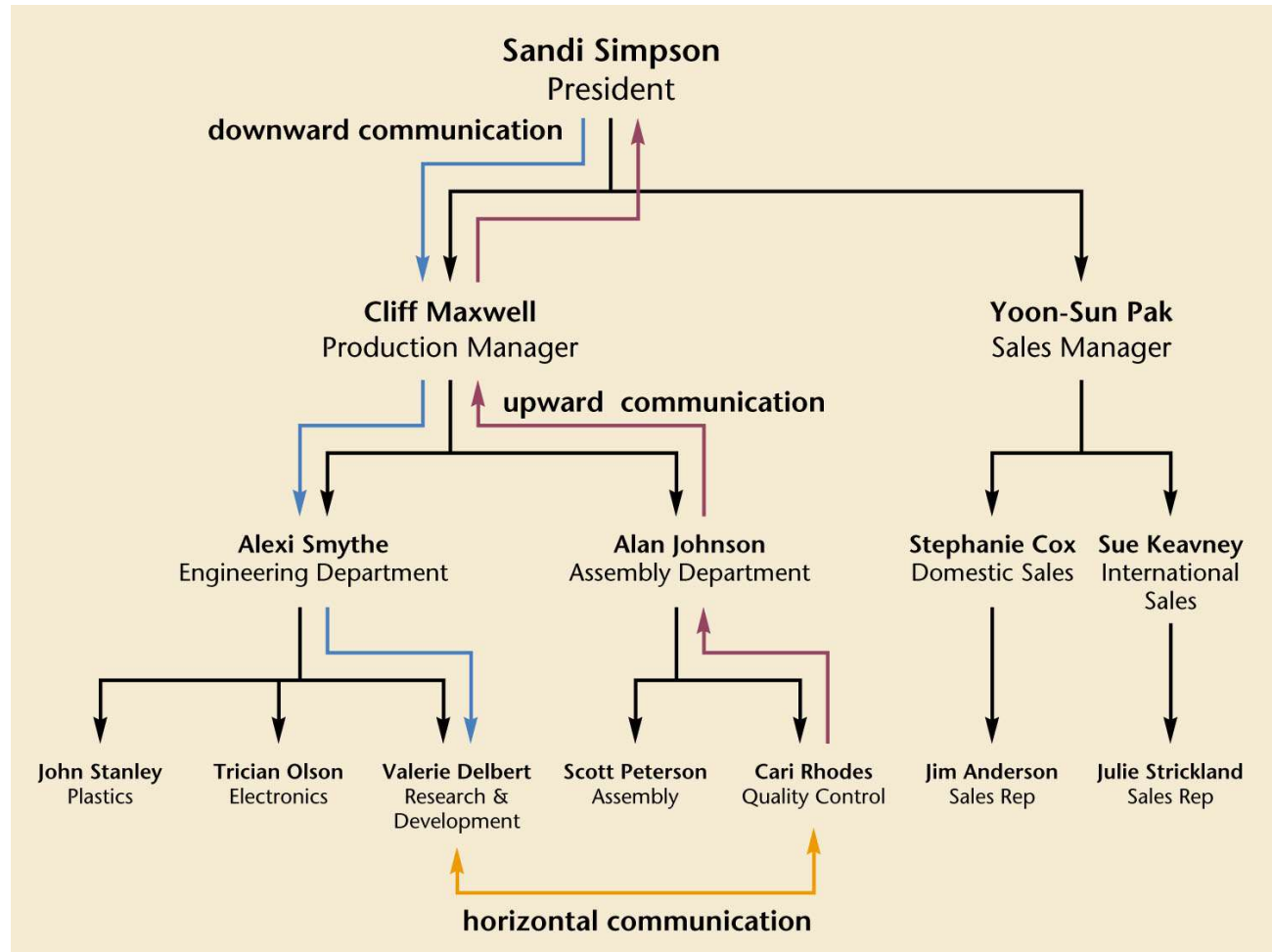
Informal Communication

An "informal organizational communication channel" refers to a method of communication within a company that happens outside of the established formal channels, often referred to as the "grapevine," where information is shared casually between employees through conversations, social interactions, or personal connections, not following a strict hierarchical structure.



Formal Communication

Formal organizational communication is the exchange of information between organizational members using official channels and protocols. It's often used to share important information, such as company policies, product updates, and financial performance.



Group Task



- ✓ In pairs, list some examples and the benefits and limitations of FORMAL and INFORMAL communication within an organisation?
- Once complete, engage in a group wide discussion, and share some examples

Examples of FORMAL Communication

- Official emails, memos, reports
- Meetings, policies, SOPs
- Chain of command communication

Advantages: Clear, documented, organized

Disadvantages: Slow, rigid, lacks personal touch

Examples of INFORMAL Communication

- Watercooler chats, social media, personal emails
- Grapevine communication (rumors, gossip)

Advantages: Fast, flexible, enhances relationships

Disadvantages: Can spread misinformation, lacks accountability

Case Study: NIKE | Failure at the top!

Since 1971, when the Swoosh logo was officially unveiled, Nike has been one of the biggest names in the sneaker world. With endorsement deals with some of the most famous names in sports, Nike solidified its place as the leader of the pack in the footwear industry and has an annual profit of \$36 billion.

But despite its spot as one of the world's most profitable apparel brands, Nike has had a few PR crises that required major repair.

In 2018, female employees spoke out about the male-dominated culture that fostered harassment and discrimination in the workplace. It started as an anonymous survey by a group of women at the company's Beaverton, Oregon headquarters about their experiences. The disturbing results were delivered to CEO Mark Parker.

Some examples of internal communication problems that went wrong here include:

- It took a renegade survey by a group of employees to reveal this toxic culture
- Lack of trust in HR
- A leader who says he was unaware of the problems
- Inefficient methods of bottom-up communication

**What
would
YOU
DO**

Case Study: NIKE | Failure at the top!

What NIKE did:

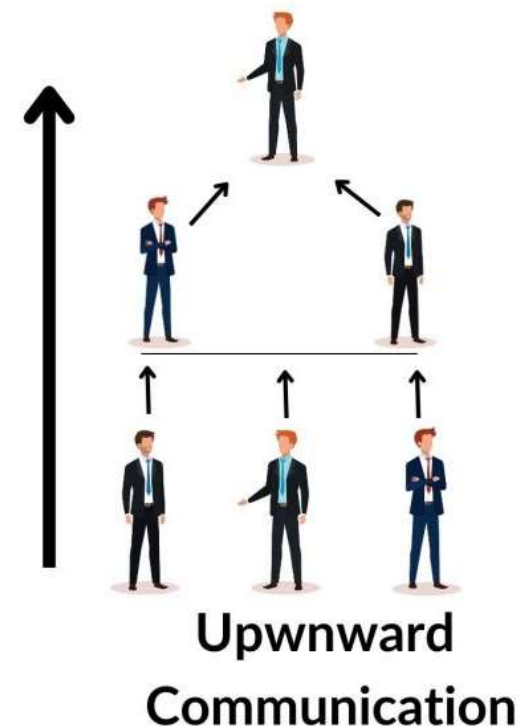
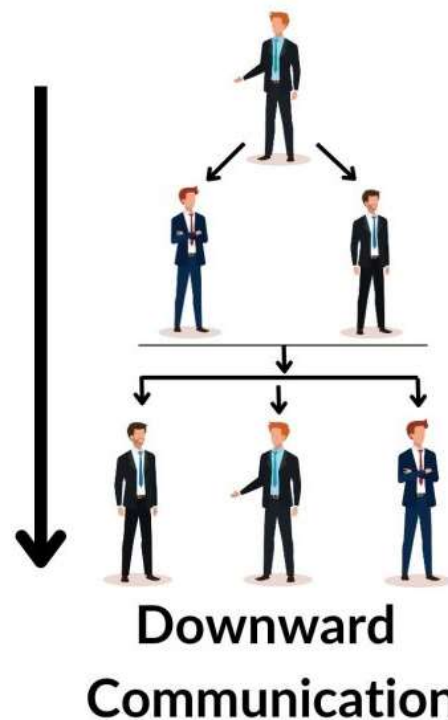
Nike took dramatic steps to fix these issues by firing C-Suite executives, including the head of diversity and inclusion, implementing mandatory management training, a commitment to a more inclusive culture, and an overhaul of their HR procedures and internal reporting processes.



Pro tip: Be proactive and get ahead of the narrative through authentic, transparent communication.

Upward and Downward Communication

"**Upward communication**" refers to information flowing from lower-level employees to higher management, like providing feedback or suggestions, while "**downward communication**" means information moving from management to employees, typically in the form of instructions or directives; essentially, upward communication is "**bottom-up**" and downward communication is "**top-down**."



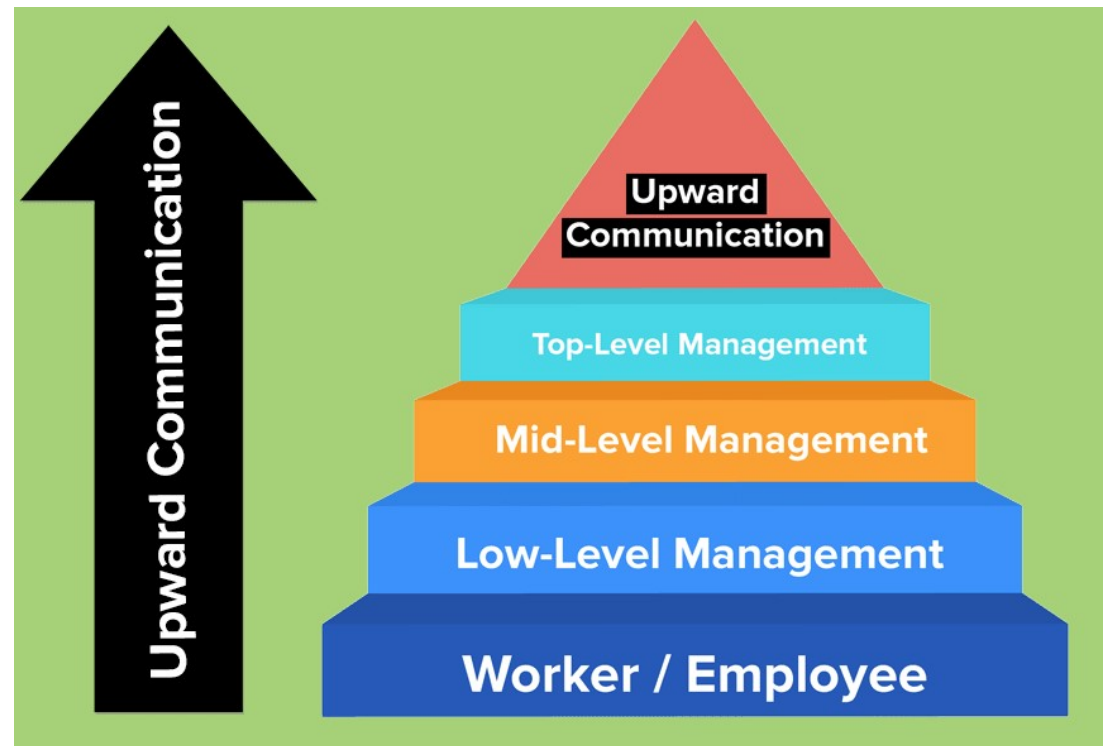
Downward Communication

An example of downward communication would be a company manager sending out an email to their team outlining a new company policy, providing clear instructions on how employees should follow it, effectively sharing information from a higher level to a lower level within the organization



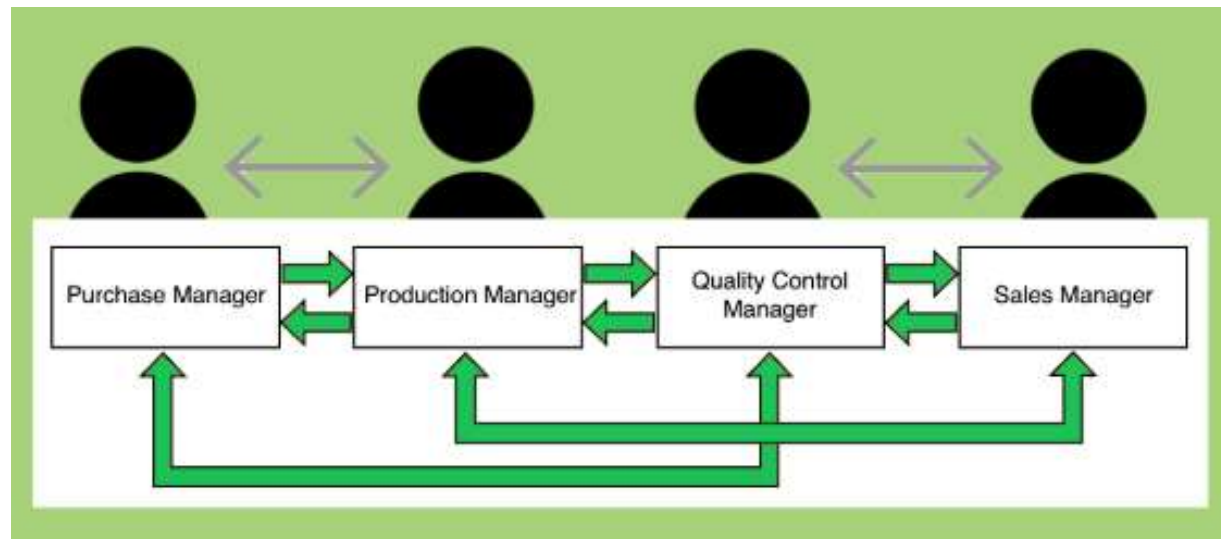
Upward Communication

An example of upward communication would be an employee sending a detailed progress report to their manager, highlighting potential roadblocks on a project, thus providing feedback and informing the higher level about the situation; essentially, any instance where a lower-level employee communicates information or concerns to a supervisor or higher management



Horizontal Communication

Horizontal communication, also known as lateral communication, is the exchange of information between people or groups at the same level in an organization. It's a vital part of a successful workplace.



Group Task

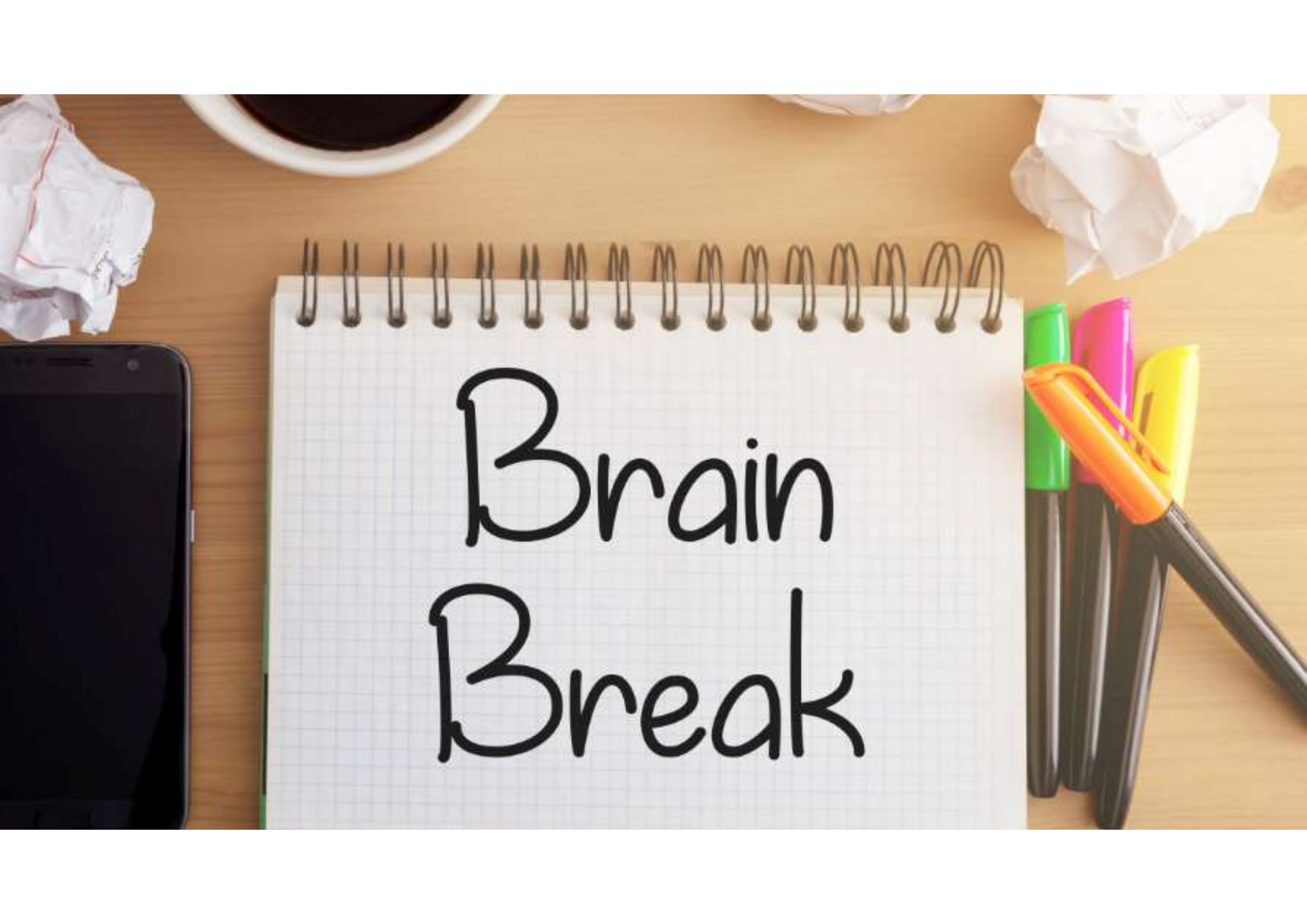


- ✓ In pairs, list examples of **UPWARD**, **HORIZONTAL** and **DOWNWARD** communication
- ✓ Then, identify if they could have improved their communication by doing something different.
- Once complete, engage in a group wide discussion, and share some examples

HOW TO AVOID MISCOMMUNICATION

TEDEd



A top-down view of a wooden desk. In the center is a spiral-bound notebook with a white grid page. The words "Brain Break" are written in a large, black, cursive font. To the left of the notebook is a black smartphone. Above the notebook is a white cup of dark coffee. To the right of the notebook are four markers with black barrels and colorful caps: green, pink, yellow, and orange. There are also two crumpled pieces of white paper on the desk, one to the left of the coffee cup and one to the right of the markers.

Brain
Break

CASE STUDY TASK



A real-world scenario of communication challenges in an organization:

- ? What communication channels did the POST OFFICE use?
- ? What flaws and failings did they encounter?

Question: How would you improve communication in this scenario?



So; How would you improve communication at the POST OFFICE?

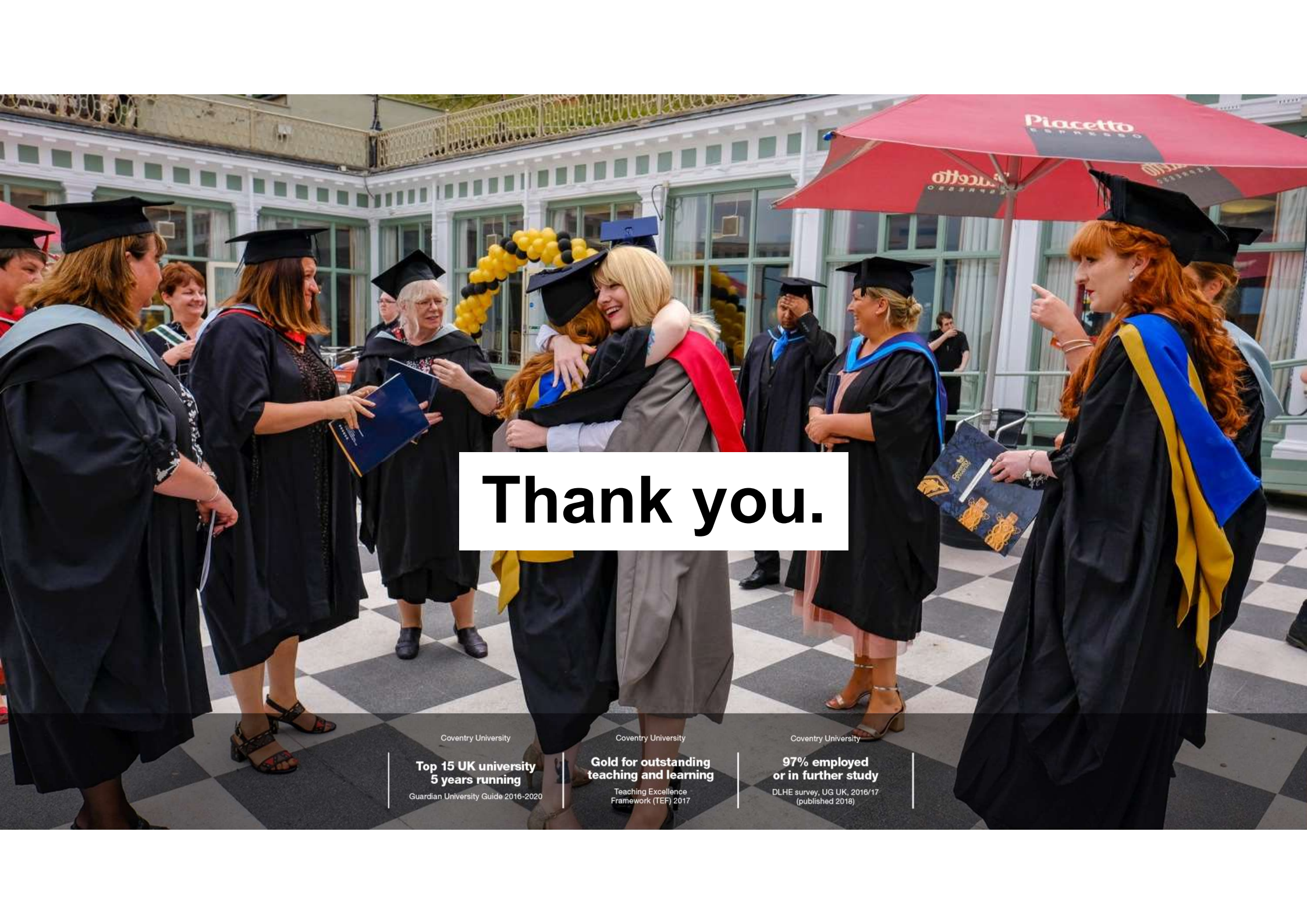
What benefits could organisational collaboration with Apple bring?



Session Learning Outcomes

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Thank you.

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